MIL-M-11745C
25 July 1980
SUPERSEDING
MIL-M-11745B(ME)
2 September 1966

MILITARY SPECIFICATION

MARKING AND LABELING OF U.S. ARMY MARINE CRAFT

This specification is approved for use by all Departments and Agencies of the Department of Defense.

1. SCOPE

1.1. Scope. This specification covers the type, location, size, proportion, and color of markings (other than shipment markings) on Army vessels.

APPLICABLE DOCUMENTS

2.1 Issues of documents. The following documents of the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal form a part of the specification to the extent specified herein.

SPECIFICATIONS

FEDERAL

H-B-621	- Brush, Stencil.
TT-P-98	- Paint, Stencil, Flat.
TT-T-291	- Thinner, Paint, Mineral Spirits, Regular & Odorless.
TT-E-489	- Enamel, Alkyd Copolymer Semigloss. (For Exterior and Interior Non-Residential Use).
UU-S-625	- Stencilboard.
RR-S-714	- Stencil Set Marking.

FSC 1910

Beneficial comments (recommendations, additions, deletions) and any pertinent data which may be of use in improving this document should be addressed to: US Army Mobility Equipment Research and Development Command, ATTN: DRDME-DS, Fort Belvoir, VA 22060 by using the self-addressed Standardization Document Improvement Proposal (DD Form 1426) appearing at the end of this document or by letter.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

MILITARY

MIL-P-514	- Plates, Identification Instruction, and Marking, Blank.
MIL-A-2877	- Aluminum and Aluminum Alloy Tape, Gray.
MIL-E-15936	- Enamel, Exterior, Gray, No. 27 (Vinyl-Alkyd) (Formula No. 122-27).
MIL-D-16791	- Detergent, General Purpose (Liquid, Nonionic).
MIL-A-22895	- Adhesive, Metal Identification Plate.
MIL-M-43719	- Marking Materials and Markers, Adhesive, Elastomeric, Pigmented; General Specification for.

STANDARDS

MILITARY

MIL-STD-12	- Abbreviations For Use On Drawings, Specifications Standards and in Technical Documents.
MS18290	- Sequence of Valve Numbering - Main Steam System.

DRAWINGS

MILITARY

U.S. Navy NAVSHIPS No. 810-1385848, Method of Marking Deck Plates for Sounding Pipes.

(Copies of specifications and standards required by contractor in connection with specific procurement functions should be obtained from the procuring activity or as directed by the contracting officer.)

2.2 Other Publications. The following documents form a part of this specification to the extent specified herein. Unless otherwise indicated, the issue in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

DEPARTMENT OF TRANSPORTATION, COAST GUARD.

Code of Federal Regulations, 46 - Shipping (Parts 41 to 69)

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Office of the Federal Register, National Archives and Records Service, General Services Administration, Washington, D.C. 20408).

AMERICAN BUREAU OF SHIPPING

Rules for Building and Classing Steel Vessels

(Application for copies should be addressed to the American Bureau of shipping, 65 Broad Street, New York, NY, 10004.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

DEPARTMENT OF THE NAVY

General Specifications for Ships of the United States Navy 1977-1978 (NAVSEAS 0902-001-5000) Section 507.

(Application for copies should be addressed to the Department of the Navy, Naval Ship Engineering Center, Washington, D.C. 20362.)

3. REQUIREMENTS

3.1 Description. Marking and labeling of U.S. Army marine craft shall be as shown on the applicable figures and as specified herein.

3.2 Material. Material shall be as specified herein. Materials not specified shall be selected by the contractor and shall be subject to all provisions of this specification (see 6.4).

3.3 Application.

3.3.1 Letters, numerals, and other markings. Block lettering and numerals as shown in figure 1 shall be used for all exterior designation markings and draft numerals. Unless otherwise specified herein, all other lettering shall be Gothic capitals; all numerals shall be Arabic. Unless otherwise specified herein, colors shall be black on a white or light-colored background, and white on a black or dark-colored background. Enamel paints conforming to TT-E-489 and MIL-E-15936 shall be considered a light background. All markings, label plates, and labels shall be located as specified in 3.4 through 3.11. If markings, label plates, or labels are obscured by the subsequent installation of curtains, rods, pipes, wiring, ducts, furniture, hull or deck fittings, canvas, or any other obstruction, they shall be relocated to a position as near as possible to the specified location and in such a manner and location that proper identification, maximum visibility, and legibility are insured.

3.3.2 Hull markings. Exterior markings of the hull shall consist of designation markings, draft numerals, and load-line markings and shall be painted the same color as the lettering. Outlines of markings on wood hulls shall consist of shallow scribe marks (maximum 1/8 inch wide by 1/8 inch deep). Outlines of markings on steel hulls shall consist of a fine bead weld in accordance with CFR 46, parts 41 to 69.

3.3.3 Pigmented elastomeric sheeting material, stenciling, and hand painting. Lifesaving and firefighting equipment indentification, locker and box content marking, nameboards, and signs in general, interior and exterior surfaces shall conform to MIL-M-43719. Consideration shall be given to the condition of the surface upon which the identifying marking means is to be applied surface treatment shall conform to MIL-M-43719 for the pigmented, elastomeric, adhesive sheeting material and MIL-D-16791 for the painted identifying marking when the stenciling and hand painting method is employed. Paint for stenciled identifying marking shall conform to TT-P-98, class 1. The paint for hand painted letters shall conform to TT-E-489, class A. Stenciled identifying marking shall be in accordance with Federal Specification RR-S-714, H-B-621, TT-T-291 and UU-S-625.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.3.4 Label plates. Unless otherwise specified (see 6.2), label plates shall conform to the requirements specified in MIL-P-514. When label plates are mounted on metal they shall be secured by means of machine screws of a size commensurate with existing label plate holesize. When label plates are mounted on wood, round headed wood screws shall be used. Fastening means shall be compatible electrochemically with the label plates and the metal surface upon which the plate is mounted. When metal plates are to be mounted where the screw holes can cause leaks; locations such as hulls, water tight or other liquid type bulkheads, decks, etc., a metal plate of the required thickness for the label plate screw length with the required tapped holes, shall be welded in place. Phenolic label plates shall not be used in locations exposed to the weather. Two component liquid polysulfide adhesive for metal label plates not exceeding 0.048 inch thick and single component, neoprene or nitrile rubber base adhesive for metal label plates not exceeding 0.030 inch thickness in accordance with MIL-A-22895 shall also be used. These adhesives are intended for attachment of metal label plates in place of mechanical attachment, suitable for exposure to severe use conditions, interior and exterior exposure, vibration, shock and high temperatures. The polysulfide type being suitable for a temperature of 250°F and the rubber base type being suitable for a temperature of 200°F. Adhesives shall not be used for the following applications:

(a) Propulsion plant identification.
(b) Die-stamped label plates.
(c) Indented corrosion resisting steel or nickel-copper label plates.
(d) Flexible or curved surfaces.
(e) Where the temperature can be over 250°F for the rubber base type adhesive.

3.3.4.1 Photographic plate (photosensitive anodized aluminum). Photographic plates shall be used for dials, wiring and schematic diagrams, instruction plates, instrument panels, gages, switch plates, and nameplates.

3.3.4.2 Color. Warning plates, when specified, shall have red lettering on a black background. All other plates shall have aluminum lettering on a black background.

3.3.5 Tags. Tags for electric cables and small-diameter pipes shall be aluminum tape conforming to MIL-A-2877. Lettering shall be 1/4 inch high, embossed at least 1/32 inch. Tags shall be as shown in figure 2.

3.3.6 Abbreviations. Abbreviations may be substituted for lengthy inscriptions, provided the meaning remains unquestionably clear. Abbreviations shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-12, (see table No. 2 for system designations, 3.9.4.1)

3.4 Designation markings. Markings shall be either black or white depending on the color of the hull. On a black hull markings shall be white. On a gray hull markings shall be black.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

3.4.1 Self-propelled vessels.

3.4.1.1 Bow. Designations shall be as shown in figure 3 and shall be located on the hull or bulwark near the bow on both port and starboard sides. The legend shall be centered at three-fourths the height from the designed load waterline to the upper edge of the deck or bulwark. Where practical, the data shall be arranged in two lines. When the alternate one-line arrangement is used, the legend "U.S. ARMY" shall be to the left of the vessel name or number. Bow designations on tugs shall be located clear of permanently-installed fender guards and bumpers.

3.4.1.2 Stern. Stern designation, "U.S. ARMY" and name or number shall be located on the hull or bulwark. On vessels having transom or elliptical sterns, designations shall be centered horizontally on the vertical centerline. On vessels having a cruiser stern, designations shall be located near the stern, on both port and starboard sides. Designations shall be centered at three-fourths the height from the designed load waterline to the upper edge of the deck or bulwark, whichever is higher. Size of the stern designation shall be as shown in figure 3.

3.4.1.3 Nameboards. When vessels 75 feet or more in overall length have pilothouses, nameboards shall be provided. Only the name or number shall be put on the nameboard. Nameboards shall be located on the outboard side of the boat deck railing abreast of the pilothouse or on the outboard side of the pilothouse top railing. Nameboards shall be wood or steel and shall be rectangular in shape. The vertical dimension shall be twice the height of the lettering used. The designation marking shall be centered on the nameboard. The size of the lettering shall be as shown in figure 3, except that if the resulting nameboard would be disproportionately large, the lettering may be reduced in height to not less than one-half that specified. Nameboards shall have gold color lettering on a black background.

3.4.2 Nonpropelled vessels.

3.4.2.1 Ship-shaped hulls. Ship-shaped nonpropelled vessels shall have exterior designation markings as specified in 3.4.1.

3.4.2.2 Barges with long deckhouse. When length of the deckhouse is 40 percent or more of the overall length of the barge, designation marking shall be centered on the port and starboard sides of the house. This same data shall also be centered on the forward and after ends of the house. All markings shall be centered vertically at the midheight of the house, or as nearly midheight as practicable. Sizes of designations shall be as shown in figure 3.

3.4.2.3 Barge with short deckhouse. When the length of the deckhouse is less than 40 percent of the overall length of the barge, designations shall be as specified in 3.4.2.4, except that the designation at the stern shall be centered on the after end of the deckhouse.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.4.2.4 Barge without deckhouse. Barge without a deckhouse, deck cargo bins, or bulwarks shall have the designation marking centered longitudinally at amidships on the port and starboard top sides. These data shall be centered vertically at 12 inches below the edge of the deck at side or 12 inches below the uppermost fender guard or rubbing strake. Sizes of designations shall be as shown in figure 3. Where practicable, these same data shall also be centered on the bow and stern immediately below the deck edge. If sufficient space is available on the bow and stern, markings shall be the same size as those used amidships. If sufficient space is not available, markings may be reduced in height to not less than one-half that specified for the amidships markings. Barge with deck cargo bins or bulwarks shall have the same designation markings, except that they shall be located at the midheight of the deck cargo bins or bulwarks at the bow and stern and at amidships, port and starboard.

3.4.2.5 Floating crane. The hulls of floating cranes shall have designations as specified in 3.4.2.4. In addition, the designation shall be centered on both sides of the crane cab. Size and form of designation shall be as shown in figure 3.

3.4.3 Sectionalized, knockdown, and collapsible craft. All sectionalized, knockdown, and collapsible type vessels shall have the applicable designation marking located as specified in 3.4.1 and 3.4.2, except where a specified legend on the side of the vessel would necessitate placing a part of the legend on each of two or more sections, the legend and number shall be placed so that it is entirely on one section.

3.5 Builder's nameplate.

3.5.1 Vessels and boats. Builder's nameplate for vessels and boats 40 feet or more long shall be as shown in figure 4 except that the vessels's assigned name shall be included. Nameplates shall be of secondary cast brass, engraved nonferrous alloy plate of not less than No. 8 American Wire Gage (AWG), or embossed nonferrous alloy sheet of not less than No. 16 AWG. The nameplate shall be installed on the forward bulkhead of the engine casing or engine room, shall have nameplates installed at the extreme forward end of the vessel on the center deck plate.

3.5.2 Special vessels and small craft. Builder's nameplate for boats less than 40 feet long, sectionalized, knockdown, and manually propelled craft, shall be as shown in figure 4 except that the vessel's assigned name shall be included. Each section of the sectionalized vessels and pontoons shall have a nameplate attached to the inner side of a transverse of longitudinal bulkhead just below the main deck level and near the main access opening to space below decks in vessels having decks, or at the centerline of the unit in boats or pontoons without decks.

3.6 Load line and draft markings. Markings shall be either black or white depending on the color of the hull. On a black hull markings shall be white. On a gray hull markings shall be black.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.6.1 Load line markings. Large self-propelled barges, tugs, and similar vessels shall have load line markings as specified in Rules for Building and Classing Steel Vessels.

3.6.2 Draft numerals. Draft numerals are manditory for all vessels, boats, or barges with a load waterline length of more than 45 feet. Numerals shall be 6 inches high, spaced at 1-foot intervals vertically.

3.6.2.1 Vertical location. Draft numerals shall be located so that the bottom edge of each numeral will establish the draft indicated by that numeral. The bottom edge of the numeral shall be measured in exact feet, normal to the designed load waterline, and above the forward and aft reference points. Numerals shall extend from one numeral below the lightest draft to one numeral above the deepest draft at which the vessel may float at bow or stern.

3.6.2.2 Forward draft numerals. The forward draft numerals shall be placed on port and starboard as near the stem as practical. The vertical draft marks shall be located in a vertical line which passes through a point established by the intersection of the design load waterline and the forward edge of the stem. The reference and starting point from which the vertical measurements for the forward draft marks will be determined shall be the intersection of the forward vertical line and the horizontal extension line from the point where the stem makes an abrupt upward curviture from the rear horizontal lower line of the keel. For a straight horizontal keel this line is an extension of the keel bottom.

3.6.2.3 After draft numerals. The after draft numerals shall be placed port and starboard as near the aft vertical as practicable. On vessels with transom sterns, the numerals shall be located horizontally on the transom at the vertical centerline of the vessel. The reference point from which the vertical measurements for the after draft marks are determined shall be the lowest point of the keel, propeller guard, or stern frame, except that on those vessels where the propeller extends below the lowest extremity of the hull or appendages, the reference point shall be the lowest point of the propeller circle.

3.7 Lifesaving and fire-fighting equipment.

3.7.1 Lifeboats. Bull markings for life boats and other boats carried on board shall consist of "U.S. Army" and the number of the parent vessel, with letters 2 inches high. The markings shall be both forward and aft. If double "bowed" on the port and starboard. On transom sterned boats mark at the bow and at the center of the transom. The numbers of each lifeboat shall be stenciled or marked on both sides of the bow in numerals 3 inches high. The cubic contents and the maximum number of persons allowed to be carried in each lifeboat shall be marked or stenciled on each side of the bow in letters and numbers 1-1/2 inches high. In addition, the maximum number of persons allowed shall be plainly marked or stenciled on top of two or more of the thwarts, in

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

letters and numbers 3 inches high. To insure that the external markings shall not be obscured when the lifeboat covers are installed, lifeboat markings shall begin 8 inches or more below the gunwhale. The lifeboat oars shall be stenciled with the words "U.S. ARMY" followed by the name or number of the parent vessel in letters and numbers 1 inch high. The markings shall be black.

3.7.2 Other lifesaving equipment. Markings for life floats and life rafts carried on board shall consist of "U.S.ARMY" and the number of the parent vessel clearly stenciled on them in letters 2 inches high. Stenciling shall appear in the center of the front and rear. The maximum number of persons allowed shall be stenciled on the top of the sides in letters 3 inches high. The oars shall be stenciled as specified in 3.7.1. The markings shall be black on floats and rafts.

3.7.3 Fire-fighting equipment. Fire hydrants, fire valves, and chemical fire-fighting control station equipment shall have the words "FIRE HYDRANT" or "FIRE VALVE," or other applicable designation, and the applicable fire station number in 1-inch red letters placed immediately above the fire-fighting equipment on the bulkhead on which they are mounted. Hose racks shall be marked "FOR FIRE" in 1-inch white letters.

3.7.4 General alarm bells. General alarm bells shall have "GENERAL ALARM BELL - WHEN BELL RINGS GO TO YOUR STATION" painted in 1-inch red letters beneath the bells on the bulkhead on which they are mounted.

3.7.5 Engine room and painting compartments. Vessels having engine rooms, painting compartments, or other space where personnel work and which are equipped with fixed CO_2 fire-fighting systems shall display the following warning statement using signs or bulkhead marking: "WARNING - WHEN SIREN SOUNDS, VACATE COMPARTMENT." The red lettering shall be 2-inch high minimum and shall be conspicously located.

3.7.6 Crash panels. Crash panels and emergency escapes shall have "EMERGENCY EXIT" painted on them in 2-inch letters in locations as follows:

(a) On compartment side of fire screen doors.
(b) On corridor side of stairwell doors.
(c) On inside of stairwell doors leading to boat deck.

Color shall be that which will be most legible against the color of the respective doors and degree of light, however, red will be used where possible.

3.7.7 High-voltage hazard spaces. Entrances to electrical controller rooms, high-voltage switchboards, and other high-voltage spaces shall display the following warning in letters not less than 1 inch high: "DANGER - HIGH VOLTAGE - AUTHORIZED PERSONNEL ONLY." Such warnings shall be painted on the doors and accesses, or on an adjacent bulkhead whichever is more conspicuous using a color contrasting to the color, however red will be used where possible.

3.8 Compartmentation labeling.

3.8.1 Bulkhead and frame numbers. All vessels, except sectionalized barges and boats less than 30-feet overall length, shall have bulkhead and frame

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

numbering plates. Each complete bulkhead shall be numbered, and whenever complete bulkheads are more than 20 feet apart, partial bulkheads, joiner bulkheads located on frames, or frames located in intermediate positions shall be labeled so that bulkhead or frame numbers are not more 20 feet apart. Bulkhead and frame numbers shall correspond to numbers shown on "as-constructed" drawings and shall be written on one line, using abbreviations "BHD 12," "FR 12," or other applicable abbreviations. Bulkhead numbers shall be located as conspicuously as possible, over important passageways or at the centerline of the ship, at or above eye level. Frame numbers shall be located on deck beams as near to the centerline of the ship as possible. All bulkhead and frame number plates shall be fastened to the midship side of the bulkhead or frame. Dimensions of label plates and lettering shall be as shown in figure 5.

3.8.2 Door, manhole, hatch, and tank labeling. Doors, manholes, and hatches shall be labeled to indicate the compartment being entered. If a door, manhole, or hatch opens into a passageway or truck to which several compartments are connected, the principal compartment shall be included on the label. For tanks, the plate shall also include the capacity in gallons.

3.9 Piping system.

3.9.1 Pipelines. Pipeline marking and flow indicating will be included on all pipelines. The selection of the color and system designation shall be in accordance with the General Specification for Ships of the United States Navy, Section 507. All paint color numbers shall be in accordance with TT-E-489.

3.9.2 Color coding. Color coding of pipe shall be in accordance with table I.

TABLE I. Color coding of pipeline.

Pipeline fluid	Color	Paint number
Potable Water	Dark blue	15044
Non-potable water	Light blue	15200
Sea water	Dark green	14062
Steam & Steam drains	White	17886
Ship service air	Tan	10324
High pressure air	Dark gray	16081
Gasoline	Yellow	13538
Fuel oil	Yellow	13538
Lube oil	Yellow	13538
Hydraulic fluid	Orange	12246
Freon	Dark purple	17100
Sewage	Gold	17043
Waste drain water	Light gray	16251
Halon	Striped, gray/white	16187/17886
Fire lines & Plugs	Red	11105

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.9.3 Pipe marking. In addition to special colors required for particular systems all systems shall be marked for identification. This marking shall be the functional name of the system; where necessary for differentiation between two or more pipes of the same system the specific services shall be included. As an example plumbing drains shall be marked "soil drain or waste drain to suit the type of drainge carried in the pipe. In addition to the specific service, the system pressure shall be indicated: for example "600 lb/in steam to forced draft blowers." For an outside diameter of two inches and larger (bare or lagged) pipe markings shall be painted on pipes or lagging using stenciled letters one inch high. For smaller pipes the lettering size shall be reduced, as necessary, but shall not be less than 3/8 inch high. Direction-of-flow arrows shall also be painted on. Where pipe sizes are too small for lettering, label plates shall be wired in place.

3.9.3.1 Method of marking. The marking shall be applied with paint and use of stencils, or vinyl cloth markers may be used. Marking shall be white for oxygen piping and black for other systems, unless the painted color of the pipe is so dark that white must be used for the marking to be legible.

3.9.3.2 Marking of pipe in unmanned shoes. Marking of piping located in tanks, voids, cofferdams, bilges and similar unmanned spaces shall be by label plate curved to fit the piping and wired in place on the piping. The label plate and wire shall be made of materials which are compatible to both the pipe and the fluid contained in the space. Marking shall be made once in each space. For machinery spaces marking shall be made at entry and at exit. Where the service of the pipe is obvious, such as short drain from a tank pipe, marking is not required. Where piping is behind protective battens, one label plate shall be attached to the batten listing all pipes behind the batten. Where marking of pipes on weather decks is required it shall be by label plate.

3.9.3.3 Method of marking deck plates. The method for marking deck plates for sounding pipes shall be as shown on drawing, NAVSHIPS No. 810-1385848.

3.9.4 Valve marking. All automatically operated valves, such as relief, pressure-regulating, pressure reducing, and back-pressure valves, shall have identification plates. Manually operable valves in piping shall have a label plate describing the functional service of the valve. Where a valve is installed below a floor plate or grating or is similarly hidden a marking shall be installed on both the valve and on the portable access plate. Individual valves in manifolds shall be seperately marked; and an information plate indicating the valve combinations for specific services shall be installed wherever necessary.

3.9.4.1 Marking of valves in systems extending outside of machinery spaces. Marking of all valves in systems extending outside of machinery spaces, (such as fire main, main drainage, fuel transfer, compressed air) other than those associated with the propulsion plant shall comply with the following:

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 20261O-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

The system name, the functional service, where appropriate the name and number of the tank, compartment, gun, or component served, and the basic location number of the valve shall be indicated for each valve. This includes valves associated with damage control.

3.9.4.2 Damage control valves. Damage control valves are those for which damage control diagrams are required to be prepared in accordance with Section 664 of General Specifications for Ships of the United States Navy. See also Section 602 for damage control closure classification labels.

3.9.4.3 Valve numbering. Valves in each system shall be numbered without respect to valves in other systems: That is, there may be several valves carrying that same number, but they will be differentiated by the system designation of the valve and piping.

3.9.4.4 Fire plug numbering. Fire plugs require no system name. However, in addition to their functional service, fire plugs and their basic location number, the designation (name and basic location number) of the cutout valve serving the fire plug shall be indicated.

3.9.4.5 Remote valve operation numbering. Where both local and remote valve operation is installed, the basic location number at both places of operation shall be that of the valve.

3.9.4.6 Unmanned space valve numbering. Where valves are located in tanks, voids, or other normally unmanned spaces the basic location number indicated shall be that of the place of remote operation.

3.9.4.7 System designation propulsion plant valves. System designation propulsion plant valves shall be in accordance with table II.

TABLE II. System designations.

System	Designation
Auxiliary machinery sea-water cooling	ASW
Control air	CA
Diesel air starting	DA
Diesel fresh water cooling	DFW
Diesel lube-oil service and transfer	DLO
Diesel oil service and purification	DOS
Diesel sea-water cooling	DSW
Fresh water drain collecting	FWDC
Fuel service	FOS
Gland seal and leak off	GS
Lubricating oil purification	LO
Main lubricating-oil service	LOS
Main machinery sea-water cooling	MSW
Shaft lubrication-oil service	SLO

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.9.4.8 Propulsion plant valves. Since the valves for the piping systems are associated with propulsion plant systems, they shall not have basic location numbers assigned. These valves shall be identified by a three-part designation in the following sequence:

Shaft or plant number;
System designation letters;
Individual valve number.

Individual valve numbers shall be assigned in sequence from the origin of a system to its terminus, exclusive of branch lines. MS18290 illustrates a sequence of valve numbering for a main steam system.

3.9.4.9 Method of marking valves. The method of marking valves shall be by marking inscribed on rims of handwheels, or by marking inscribed on a circular size or location prevents the use of one of these methods, marking inscribed on a rectangular label plate to fit the pipe adjacent to the valve, wired in place for easy reading, shall be used. An insulating material shall first be wrapped around the bare pipe to prevent electrolitic action between pipe, label and wire. Care shall also be taken in the selection of the wire to prevent electrolytic action where it is attached to the label.

3.9.4.10 Label inscriptions. The inscription shall indicate specifically the designation of the fitting; for example:

"Fire Main Cutoff"
"Potable Water"
"Non-Potable Water-Unfit for Drinking"
"Soil Drain"
"Waste Drain"
"600 lb/in^2 Steam"
"High Pressure Air"
"High Pressure Hydraulic Oil"
"Oxygen"
"Halon"
"Sea Water"

3.9.4.11 Method of marking flood cocks, sea valves, deck plates and air escapes at fuel oil tanks. Flood cock and sea valve labels, and labels on valves, deck plates, and air escapes at fuel oil tanks shall have depressed lettering, and the depressions shall be filled in with red enamel.

3.9.4.12 Special deck plate inscriptions. Deck plates over sounding tubes, tank fill pipes, and valve operating gear shall be inscribed with the name of the sounding tube, the tank number and contents, or operating valve reached through the deck plates in 1/4-inch letters and in abbreviations if practicable.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.9.4.13 Manifold labels. Manifold labels shall be located on the bulkhead over the center of the group of valves, and just above the valve label plates. If there is no bulkhead ajoining, manifold label plates shall be located on the manifold box or box casing. The plates shall be as shown in figure 6. In addition to the manifold label, each valve in the manifold shall be labeled. For valves with wheels located beneath the floor plates, a label plate repeating the label on the valve shall be set into the top of the floor plates close to the cover giving access to the valve.

3.10 Miscellaneaous labeling.

3.10.1 Electrical cable tags. Electrical cable tags as specified in 3.3.5 shall be installed on all cables, except the non-vital ones which are located wholly within a compartment in such a manner that they can be traced. Cables shall be tagged as near as practicable to each point of connection, on both sides of decks, bulkheads, and other barriers, and at intervals such that the length of cable between cable tags does not exceed 50 feet.

3.10.2 Hoist load limits. Each davit, boom, hoist, derrick, and hoisting mechanisms shall be provided with a label plate. The plate shall indicate "Safe Working Load," followed by the number of pounds or long tons maximum load the item is designed to carry. Lettering shall be 1/2 inch high.

3.10.3 Box and locker markings. The contents of each deck box, locker, and storage container for general use shall be clearly identified. Marking shall be stenciled letters 3 inches high, specifying contents of box or locker and stowage capacity in pounds, bushels, or number of units stowed. Marking shall be located in center of top or front, and on sides or ends, as the size and visibility of the box or locker indicates.

3.10.4 Warning boards. Tank ships, oil barges, and similar vessels which carry flammable, explosive, or other dangerous materials shall be equipped with portable boards of wood, exterior plywood, or sheet steel. These minimum 2-inch high letters, except that the word "WARNING" shall be a minimum of twice the size of the other lettering.

WARNING

No Open Lights

No Smoking

No Visitors

3.10.5 Special labeling. Any special markings required (see 6.2) for ease of maintenance or repair shall be applied in a manner consistent with similar type markings.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

3.11 Workmanship. The fabrication and installation of label plates and the application of labeling, marking, and identification shall be consistent with standard marine practice.

4. QUALITY ASSURANCE PROVISIONS

4.1 Responsibility for inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract, the contractor is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the contractor may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the specification where inspections are deemed necessary to assure supplies and services conform to prescribed requirements.

4.1.1 Component and material inspection. The contractor is responsible for insuring that materials used are manufactured, examined, and tested in accordance with referenced specifications, standards, and other publications (see 2.1 and 2.2).

4.2 Examination. Marking and labeling of each marine craft shall be examined for the following defects. Presence of one or more defects shall be cause for rejection.

101. Letters and numbers not as shown on applicable figures.
102. Colors of background not as specified.
103. Colors of letters and numerals not as specified.
104. Markings, label plates, and labels not located as specified.
105. Exterior designation markings, draft numerals, and load markings not applied as specified.
106. Outlines of exterior hull markings not scribed, welded, or painted as specified.
107. Stenciling and hand painting not as specified.
108. Label plates made of material other than that specified.
109. Label plates not secured as specified.
110. Phenolic plates used in locations exposed to weather.
111. Photographic plates not as specified.
112. Tags not as specified.
113. Unauthorized abbreviations used.
114. Location, size, and accuracy of designation markings not as specified.
115. Nameboards not as specified, improper location, unspecified material, wrong dimension, or improper color.
116. Builder's nameplate not provided or not as specified.
117. Load line and draft marks not as specified.
118. Life-saving equipment not marked as specified.
119. Fire-fighting equipment not marked as specified.
120. General alarm bells not marked as specified.
121. Crash panels not labeled as specified.

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

122. Compartment labeling not as specified.
123. Piping system not identified as specified.
124. Electrical systems not marked as specified.
125. Hoist load limit label plates not provided or not as specified.
126. Box and locker markings not as specified.
127. Flammable, explosive, or dangerous material warning boards not provided when applicable or not as specified.
128. Workmanship not as specified.

5. PACKAGING

Not applicable to this specification.

6. NOTES

6.1 Intended use. This specification is intended for use in the marking and labeling of U.S. Army marine vessels and the various components of these vessels. It is not applicable to vessels of other activities or services.

6.2 Ordering data. Procurement documents should specify the following:

(a) Title, number, and date of this specification.
(b) Label plates, if other than in accordance with MIL-P-514 (see 3.3.4).
(c) Special marking required (see 3.10.5).

6.3 Revision changes. Asterisks are not used in this revision to identify changes with respect to the previous issue due to the extensiveness of the changes.

6.4 Recycled Material. It is encouraged that recycled material be used when practical as long as it meets the requirements of the specification (see 3.2).

Custodian:
Army - ME

Review activity:
DLA - CS

User activity:
Navy - OS

Preparing activity:
Army - ME

Project 1910-A001

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

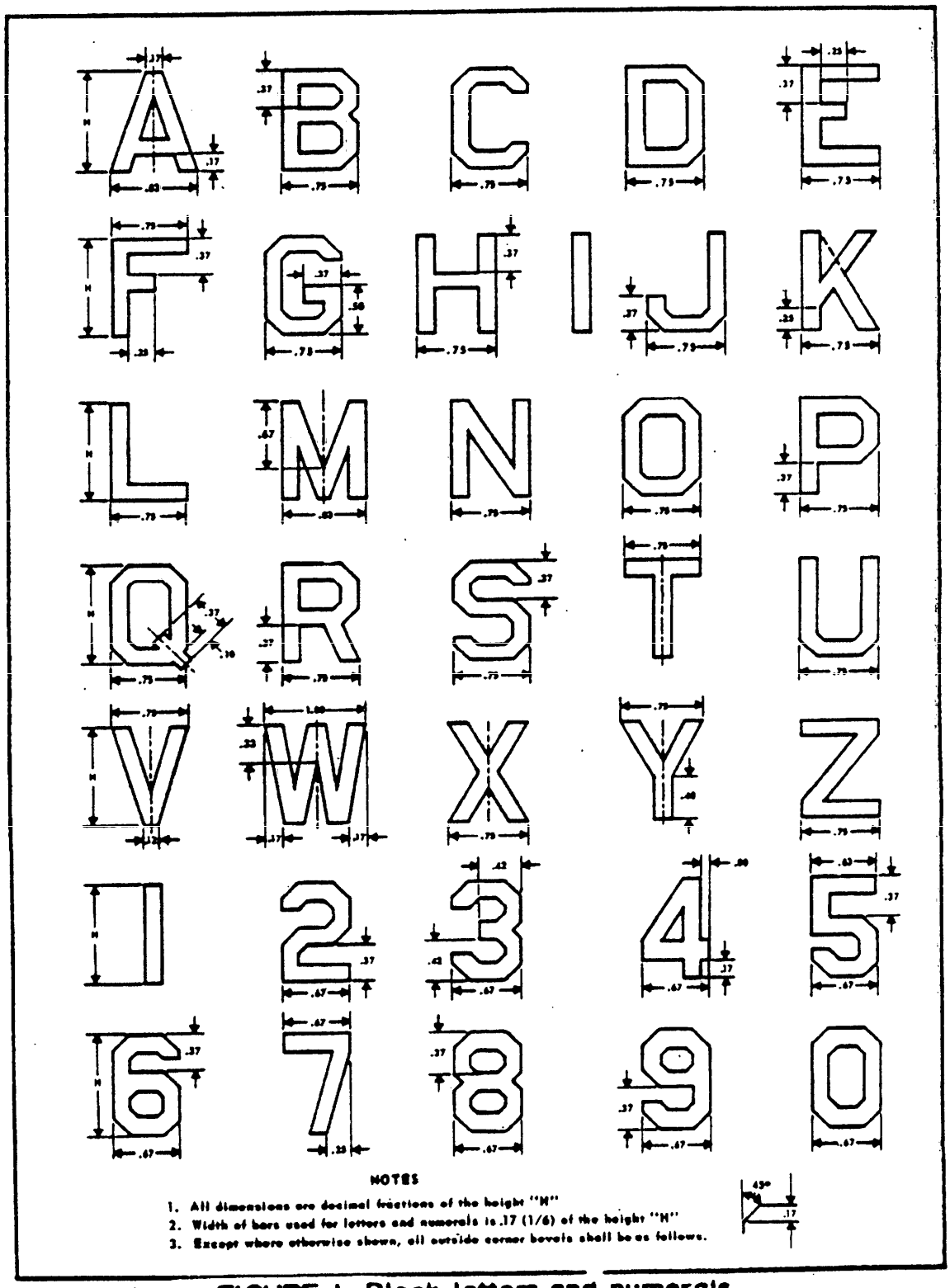


FIGURE 1. Block letters and numerals.

X836

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

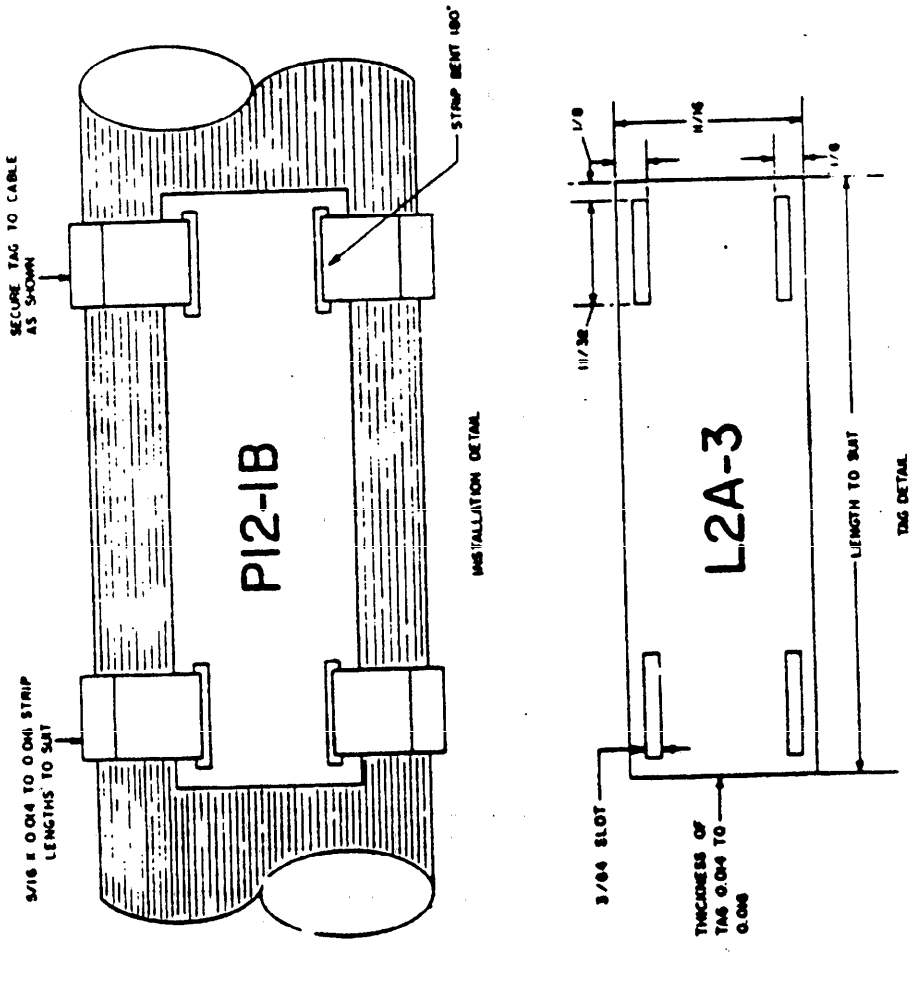


FIG.2 Typical cable tags.

X-837A

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



PREFERRED DESIGNATION ARRANGEMENT



ALTERNATE DESIGNATION ARRANGEMENT

TABLE 1. DIMENSIONS FOR DESIGNATIONS

SIZE OF VESSEL, BOAT, OR BARGE (LOAD WATER LINE LENGTH)	DIMENSIONS IN INCHES		
	A	B	C
LESS THAN 20'-0"	3	4	2
20'-0" TO LESS THAN 40'-0"	4-1/2	6	3
40'-0" TO LESS THAN 70'-0"	6	8	4
70'-0" TO LESS THAN 125'-0"	7-1/2	10	5
125'-0" AND OVER	9	12	6

FIG. 3 Designation arrangements.

X838

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202640-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.

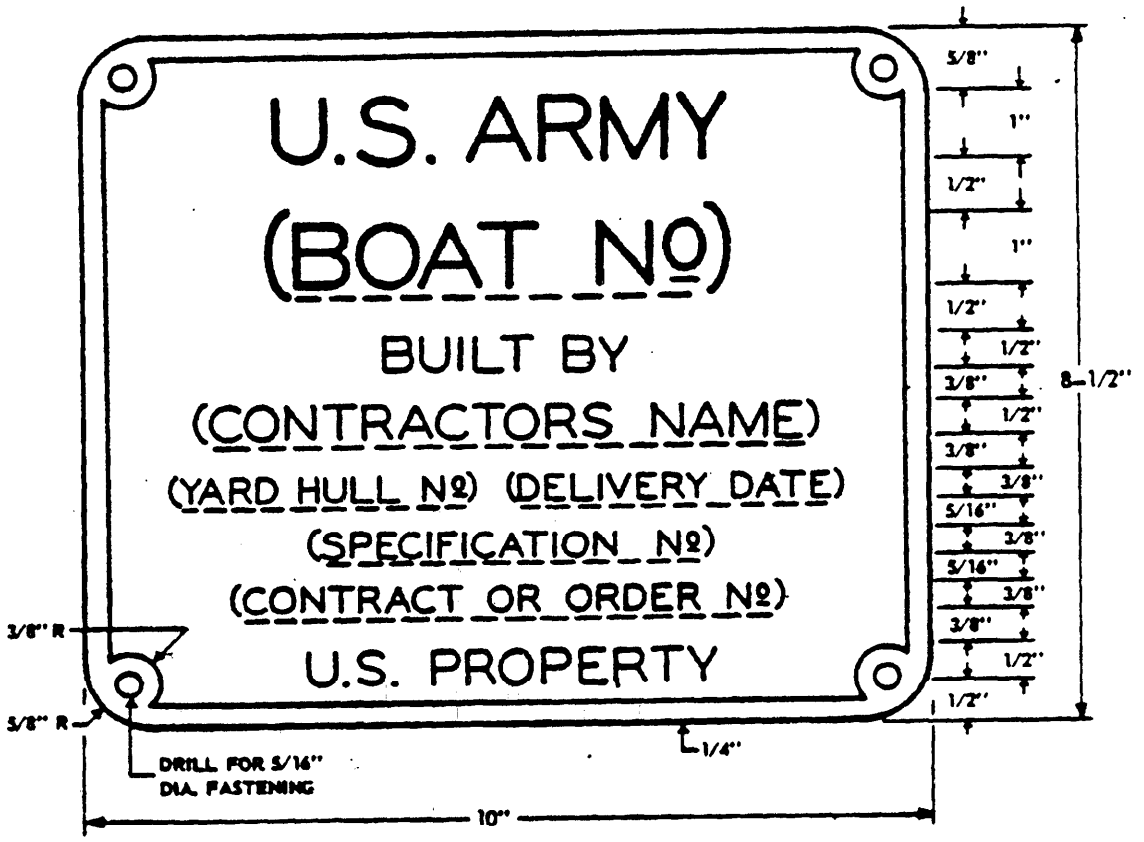
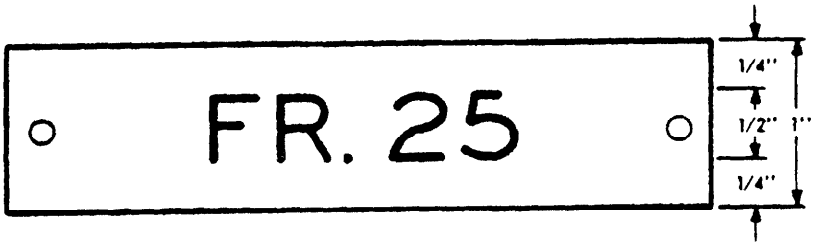


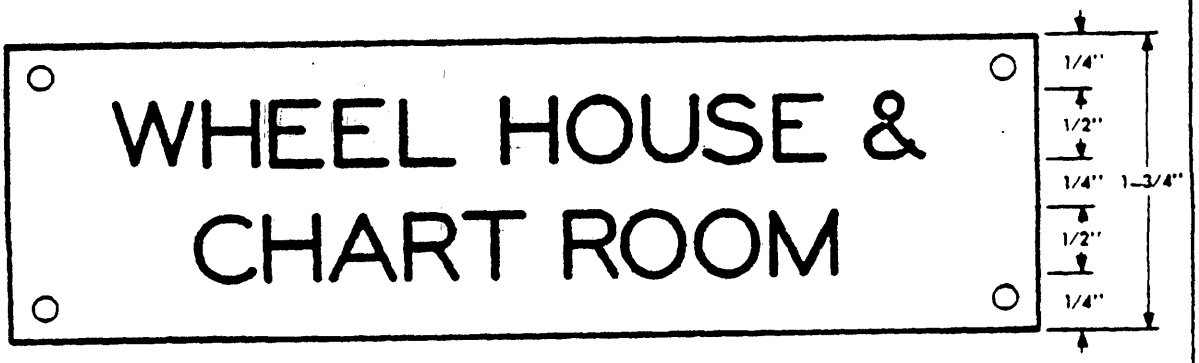
FIG. 4 Typical builders nameplate.

x839

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.



TYPICAL SINGLE LINE LABEL PLATE
(LIMITED TO 16-LETTER T.TLES)

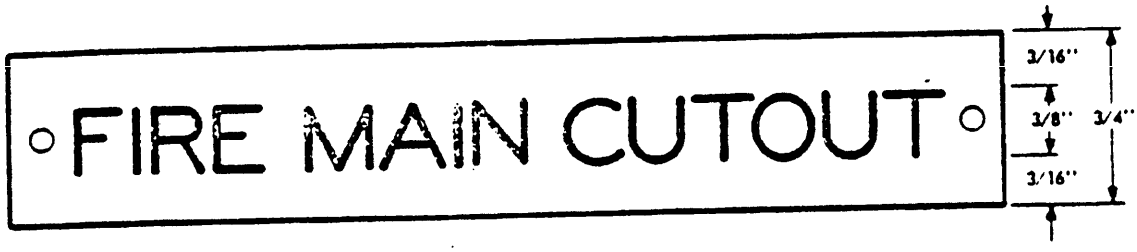


TYPICAL DOUBLE LINE LABEL PLATE
(FOR TITLES OF MORE THAN 16 LETTERS)

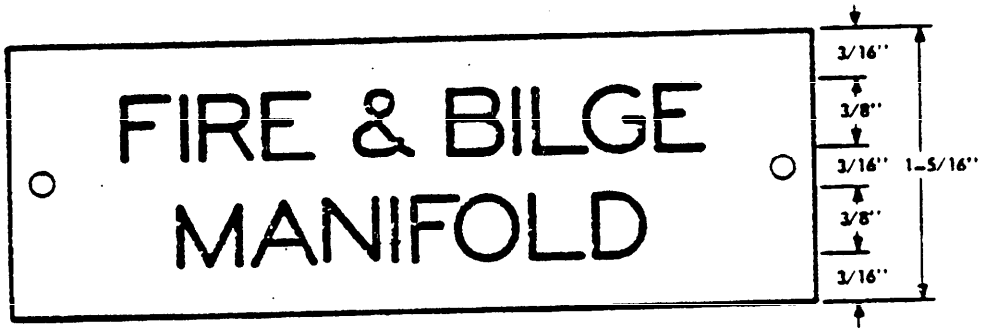
FIG. 5 Typical bulkhead, frame, door, hatch, and manhole lable plates.

X840

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 202610-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the currentversion before use.



TYPICAL SINGLE LINE LABEL PLATE
(LIMITED TO 16-LETTER TITLE)



TYPICAL DOUBLE LINE LABEL PLATE
(FOR TITLES OF MORE THAN 16 LETTERS)

FIG. 6 Typical piping fittings labels.

X841

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2020-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

STANDARDIZATION DOCUMENT IMPROVEMENT PROPOSAL

(See Instructions – Reverse Side)

1. DOCUMENT NUMBER	2. DOCUMENT TITLE

3a. NAME OF SUBMITTING ORGANIZATION	4. TYPE OF ORGANIZATION *(Mark one)*
	☐ VENDOR
b. ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)*	☐ USER
	☐ MANUFACTURER
	☐ OTHER *(Specify)*: _____

5. PROBLEM AREAS

a. Paragraph Number and Wording:

b. Recommended Wording:

c. Reason/Rationale for Recommendation:

6. REMARKS

7a. NAME OF SUBMITTER *(Last, First, MI)* – Optional	b. WORK TELEPHONE NUMBER *(Include Area Code)* – Optional
c. MAILING ADDRESS *(Street, City, State, ZIP Code)* – Optional	8. DATE OF SUBMISSION *(YYMMDD)*

(TO DETACH THIS FORM, CUT ALONG THIS LINE.)

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.

INSTRUCTIONS: In a continuing effort to make our standardization documents better, the DoD provides this form for use in submitting comments and suggestions for improvements. All users of military standardization documents are invited to provide suggestions. This form may be detached, folded along the lines indicated, taped along the loose edge *(DO NOT STAPLE)*, and mailed. In block 5, be as specific as possible about particular problem areas such as wording which required interpretation, was too rigid, restrictive, loose, ambiguous, or was incompatible, and give proposed wording changes which would alleviate the problems. Enter in block 6 any remarks not related to a specific paragraph of the document. If block 7 is filled out, an acknowledgement will be mailed to you within 30 days to let you know that your comments were received and are being considered.

NOTE: This form may not be used to request copies of documents, nor to request waivers, deviations, or clarification of specification requirements on current contracts. Comments submitted on this form do not constitute or imply authorization to waive any portion of the referenced document*(s)* or to amend contractual requirements.

(Fold along this line)

(Fold along this line)

DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

NO POSTAGE NECESSARY IF MAILED IN THE UNITED STATE

OFFICIAL BUSINESS
PENALTY FOR PRIVATE USE $300

BUSINESS REPLY MAIL
FIRST CLASS PERMIT NO. 12062 WASHINGTON D. C.
POSTAGE WILL BE PAID BY THE DEPARTMENT OF THE ARMY

Commander
US Army Mobility Equipment Research & Development Command
ATTN: DRDME-DS
Fort Belvoir, VA 22060

Source: https://assist.dla.mil -- Downloaded: 2026-10-17T21:56Z
Check the source to verify that this is the current version before use.